

— *A self-audit, not a sales pitch*

The 7-Point Revenue Leak Checklist.

*A 15-minute self-audit for Orange County business owners
— find the leaks before they find you.*

INTRODUCTION

Why this exists.

Most local businesses aren't struggling because of a bad product. They're struggling because revenue is quietly walking out the door — and nobody's watching the door.

It's the after-hours call that went to voicemail. The customer from 2023 who'd happily book again if anyone asked. The Google listing nobody's touched since the phone number changed. The lead form that sends to an inbox the owner stopped checking last spring.

None of that is a *marketing* problem. It's an infrastructure problem. And the first step to fixing it is knowing where the leaks are.

This is the same checklist we walk through on the first thirty minutes of every diagnosis call. Seven checkpoints. Three honest yes/no questions each. One concrete fix you can run this week without hiring anyone — *us included*.

Grab a coffee. Set a timer. Be honest with the answers — nobody's reading them but you.

— *Matthew Sr., Client Relations & Sales Director*

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CHECKPOINT 01

Speed-to-Response.

THE LEAK

A new lead hits your inbox at 7:42pm. By the time you see it at 8:30am the next morning, they've already talked to two competitors — and booked one.

CHECK YOURSELF

- ☐ Every new inquiry — web form, Google, Facebook, Instagram DM — gets a real reply in under five minutes, 24/7.
- ☐ You know exactly what happens to a lead that comes in at 11pm on a Saturday.
- ☐ If you're on a job site for six hours, leads still get answered.

FIX IT THIS WEEK

Set up a single autoresponder on your most-used inbound channel — even a plain text reply that says “*Got your message — we'll be in touch within the hour*” buys you time and keeps the lead warm. It is not the real fix. But it stops the worst of the bleeding while you build the real one.

CHECKPOINT 02

Dormant Customers.

THE LEAK

You have hundreds of past customers who already trust you, already paid you, already know your work — and you haven't said a word to them in two years.

CHECK YOURSELF

- ☐ You can pull a clean list of every customer from the last three years in under ten minutes.
- ☐ You've reached out to past customers — by text or email — at least once in the last 90 days.
- ☐ You know your repeat-customer rate. The *actual* number, not a guess.

FIX IT THIS WEEK

Open the spreadsheet. Pick ten customers from 12–24 months ago. Send each one a short personal text — no offer, no template, just “*Hey, it's been a minute — everything still good on your end?*” Watch what happens. That's the engine you're not running.

CHECKPOINT 03

Local Search Presence.

THE LEAK

Someone in Mission Viejo searches for what you do. Your competitor — the one with worse reviews and a website from 2014 — shows up first. You show up on page two, if at all.

CHECK YOURSELF

- ☐ Your Google Business Profile has your current phone, hours, address, and at least one photo from this calendar year.
- ☐ You show up in the local map pack for the main thing you do plus your city name.
- ☐ If you ask ChatGPT or Perplexity “who’s a good [your trade] in [your town],” your name comes up.

FIX IT THIS WEEK

Google your own business. Then google your top three competitors. Note the differences — photos, review count, response rate, the categories they’ve selected, the services listed. Most of that gap is free to close. You just have to log in.

CHECKPOINT 04

Review & Reputation Loop.

THE LEAK

Your best customer last month would give you five stars in a heartbeat — but nobody asked, so they didn’t, and the next person searching you sees a three-month-old review with no response.

CHECK YOURSELF

- ☐ Every completed job ends with a real, specific ask for a Google review.
- ☐ You respond to every review — good and bad — within 48 hours.
- ☐ You’ve added at least three new reviews in the last 30 days.

FIX IT THIS WEEK

Pick your five favorite customers from the past 60 days. Text them — by name, personally — and ask for a review. Include the direct link. That’s it. Don’t automate this one yet — *you* asking matters more than a system asking, at this scale.

CHECKPOINT 05

Lead Capture on the Website.

THE LEAK

Your site gets visitors. Most of them leave. You don't know who they were, what they looked at, or what would've made them stay — because there's nothing on the page that asks.

CHECK YOURSELF

- ☐ Your site has a clear way to contact you — phone, form, or text — visible without scrolling, on every page.
- ☐ You know how many leads your site generated last month. The number, not a feeling.
- ☐ Your forms send to an inbox you actually check — and someone replies the same day.

FIX IT THIS WEEK

Open your site on your phone. Time how long it takes to find your phone number. If it's more than three seconds, that's the fix. Move it to the top. Make it tappable. Don't redesign anything — just make the number obvious.

CHECKPOINT 06

Follow-Up After First Contact.

THE LEAK

A lead reached out. You replied once. They didn't reply back. You moved on. They didn't — they just got busy, and now they're somebody else's customer.

CHECK YOURSELF

- ☐ Every new lead gets at least three follow-up touches across five days if they go quiet.
- ☐ You know which lead is at which stage *right now*, without having to dig.
- ☐ No lead has ever fallen through the cracks because it was a busy week.

FIX IT THIS WEEK

Pull your last twenty inbound leads. Count how many you followed up with more than once. If it's under half, that's the gap. Pick three from this week and send a short second message today — “*Wanted to make sure my last note didn't get buried — still want me to send over a quote?*” works fine.

CHECKPOINT 07

Tracking & Visibility.

THE LEAK

You're working hard, the phone rings sometimes, money comes in some weeks more than others — and you couldn't tell us, with numbers, why.

CHECK YOURSELF

- ☐ You know — *honestly* — how many leads came in last month, from which channel.
- ☐ You know your close rate. From lead, to quote, to booked job.
- ☐ You can name the one number that, if it moved 10%, would change your year.

FIX IT THIS WEEK

Open a fresh spreadsheet. Four columns: date, source, name, status. Start logging every new lead that comes in, by hand, for the next two weeks. It is not elegant. It is not automated. But by day fourteen, you'll know more about your business than you've known in two years — and you'll know exactly where to build first.

SCORING

So — how'd it go?

Count the boxes you couldn't honestly check.

0–2 unchecked. You're running tighter than most. The leaks you have are probably small. Keep the systems you've built.

3–4 unchecked. This is where most local businesses live. Each one of these is fixable — but they compound. Worth a conversation.

5+ unchecked. Revenue is leaving the building. Not because of anything you're doing wrong — because the infrastructure was never built. That's the good news. Infrastructure is *buildable*.

IF YOU'D LIKE A SECOND SET OF EYES

Thirty honest minutes.

If you checked three or more boxes on the leak side, we should talk. Thirty minutes. Free. No pitch deck, no follow-up sequences, no upsell — just an honest look at what we'd build first and what we'd tell you to skip.

We only take on clients in Orange County — Mission Viejo, RSM, Ladera Ranch, Aliso Viejo, San Clemente, and the neighbors in between. If that's you, we'd be glad to hear what's going on.

If it sounds like us, reach out below. If not, no hard feelings — we only take on what we can deliver for.

THE EASIEST WAY IN

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— *Branch and Root Consulting*

Branching your business out from a rooted foundation.